

Burners Ancestry

The races and peoples of the Dragon Isles, for use with Burners (see [[Burners Adventure Game]]).

Reading an ancestry block. Each entry ends in a short pick-list. Map them like this:

- **Themes** — feed your Burners **Theme**: your name or alias and a short “look” (“*Alu’Kel* — *desert screamer*”). Also a mine for Traits.
 - **Traits** — take as Burners **Traits** under the fitting Approach. Up to four per Approach level, filled in play from Trait slots (see *Gaining Traits* in [[Burners Adventure Game]]).
 - **Assets** — gear. Buy from [[Burners Equipment]]; exotic pieces are in [[Burners Arms and Armor]], with **Slots** assigned there.
 - **Signatures** — powers and named edges earned in play — see [[Burners Principles#Earned in play]]. Eldar may earn two per character level instead of one (see *Eldar* below). Spells that are plainly spells are learned through [[Burners Sorcerie]] / [[Burners Spells]] instead.
 - **Gifts** (Drissi, Karrock) — take a **Gifts Signature**; each gift manifested is an innate Asset while it shows.
 - **Signature Assets** — name items in play, never at creation (see [[Burners Arms and Armor]]).
 - **Hooks** — hand one to the Referee. It is a lever, and levers get pulled.
 - **Paths** — goals and quests. Advancement is on [[Burners Experience]]. A completed Path pays off in fiction, Traits, or a Signature emerging.
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Part 1: Ancestry

The following set of character “ancestries” are recommended choices for your character represent distinctive and dominant cooperative cultures in the present time.

You are recommended to choose one of them. This provides you with a ready-made distinctive “look” and cultural heritage that fits into the campaign setting, and keeps it simple for other players to understand and relate to you.

However, if you have a creative idea of your own then feel free to discuss it with the Referee. Some players have created truly unique characters such as a “winter wolf” or “baby platinum dragon”. This can be a very challenging roleplaying experience. If you choose to do this then you are recommended to create close tie-ins to at least one other character to help you integrate with the fantasy world.

Eldar

Northmarens and Southmarens use the ordinary XP column on [[Burners Experience]] — one Signature per character level, earned in play.

Eldar are the older peoples: Æthiiri (Elves), Illythrhi, Alu, Avathar, Baal, Drissi, Dwür, Karrock, Kith, Vôzen, and kin. They use the Eldar column (double XP). They may earn two Signatures per character level instead of just one. Ancestry is what lets those Signatures be gifts a mortal cannot claim: low light, charm, sleep, and the like. Full note: [[Burners Experience#Eldar]].

Northmarens

Northmarens are widely varied peoples from river and sea-side kingdoms on the northwestern shores of the Dragon Sea, such as Alglondor, Dorthonien, and Lyonesse. They are young and impetuous and eager for glory in battle, conquest, exploration and trade, however they are not as advanced as their smaller southern cousins, the Southmarens. They are divided into countless kingdoms and free cities, such as Alglondor, Dorthonien, Belerion, and Lyonesse, but stand united against the threat of bloodthirsty Nan-Avathar. They are allies with Eldar such as of Elves, Belerions and Dwür, and plagued by foes such as the Avathars and Illythrhi.

Northmarens are a diverse lot, and customs vary between regions, since most never leave their home town. A typical Northmaren stands six feet tall, a full head taller than their smaller Southmaren cousins, and some of their larger men are seven feet tall. Some tend towards single-mindedness and perfectionism, like the Dwür who taught them the arts of stone and steel. Yet others love nature, forests and the sea, like the Elves who taught them the arts of archery, swordsmanship, wood lore, and prayer. Most Northmarens have a profound sense of fear and distrust for magic, especially Avathar blood magic or necromancy, except for obviously Elven “hallowed” magic such as songs to Lunara. Witches and vampires are hunted and cleansed with holy fires of Pyrose.

Northmaren strongholds are works of engineering that would make the Dwür proud. The most famed is the city-fortress of Alglondor, the “Silverplume”.

Northmaren Names: Alrik, Godfred, Bjarieson, Gunnar, Ognin, Thorkell, Ulf, Ragnar, Thorir, Leikrison, Knut, Sigrid, Saxe, Hallki, Geirla, Idin, Leif, Sigfi, Horgi, Iwar, Asbralson, Scandlo, Odik, Sturlison, Ognin, Thorki, Bjarieson, Hrike, Agingrson, Tholmfi, Alldolfr, Axir, Herison, Orken, Fasti, Artmav, Saxe, Geirla, Idin, Leido, Artlidson, Edil, Mundi, Leikrison, Hugi, Horhi, Arnkend, Axek, Hallki, Berdi, Mundi, Summi, Gudmi, Arar, Knute, Sokki, Loomis.

Homelands: Alglondor, Lyonesse, Dorthonien, Belerion.

Themes: Alglond, Dorthon, Taurithren Ranger, Druid, Elf Friend, Arms Master, Hallow, Knight, Noble Born, Paladin, Herald.

Traits: hard to kill, strong, archery, swordsmanship, spearman, honorable, courageous, heraldry, music, scouting, bowyer/fletcher, bushcraft, wood lore.

Assets: cuirass, plate armor, sword, lance, poleax, longsword, rondel, warhorse, canoe, silk rope, Elven cloak, hunting bow, long bow, war bow, bread, cheese, Elven way bread.

Signatures: detect evil, sense truth, holy aura, Elfsight, Starlight, Blessing of Lunara, Healing of Lunara, Purify water, Find Path, horse whisperer.

Hooks: family slain by Avathars, impious, deserter, fears undead.

Paths: battle the Avathars, earn knight’s armor, become a knight, build a river fort, strengthen the forest, purify forest tainted by Avathars, hunt Avathars, win new lands in the south.

Southmarens

Southmarens are the sophisticated citizens of the seafaring cities of Aquila and the Empire of Harnendor. They are ambitious merchants and adventurous scoundrels with a famous wanderlust and are thus found everywhere, recognizable as slightly smaller, swarthier, and more calculating than Northmarens, with fast hands and a ready smile. They are true rogues who rely on their exceptional luck, opportunism, quick wits, sharp blade, and even sharper quips. The center of their world is Aquila, the infamous “City of Thieves” and seat of their golden Southmaren Empire of Harnendor, with its decadent aristocratic society, dreaming artists,

clever thieves, silver-tongued merchants, and scheming black wizards. Their empire extends as far north as Kitania, surrounding majestic Madrigal, “City of Birds”. Southmarens are famed for their ships, horses, skill in arms, and the sense of style they bring to all they do.

The Southmaren Empire covers the Dragon Sea, with many hidden trade routes, ports, cities, and lands on its shores, such as Kitania, the Rochir Plains, Dagor, sorcerous cities the Sea of Fallen Stars, the deserts of Haradjia, and the southern Emerald Isles. As a result, the Southmarens are a varied people, a melange of cultures of Aquilans, Kitanians, Rochir, Northmaren immigrants, and Haradjin. Southmarens have intermittent alliances and wars with the ever changing Northmaren kingdoms, hampered by their propensity to raid the rich Southmaren lands. They are also neighbors of Eldar such as the Mirjiador Alu, Baal of Akkar, Guldurine Alu, Haradjinn Alu, and know how to appease and trade with them, but are bitter enemies of the Gobbah and Drisi.

Southmaren nobles are most often found in the major cities of Aquila and Madrigal. Nobles are expected by society to have skill in business, in feats of arms, as well as athletics, music, dancing, and other arts. All must be done with sprezzatura, the air of nonchalance of doing many things well with little effort or concern.

Southmaren Names: Marozzo, Faxx, Hristo, Elo, Rendo, Pulg, Thorkell, Talin, Thaxas, Thax, Pax, Falar, Thorkar, Basharat, Killian, Tia, Mira, Alya, Avaxa, Ava, Vlasha, Vlana, Thorkell, Talin, Fay, Thaxas, Jakartai, Than, Pax, Thoren, Thorin, Falkar, Thorkar, Avar, Pulgh, Basharat, Giovanni, Rezz, Seco, Ansus, Sabe, Rento, Tiusio, Garso, Mundi, Anez, Veno, Zaido, Guiro, Arin, Ruenzo, Vadi, Garceo, Rila, Duso, Luadio, Miro, Cuso, Reiala, Tero, Sesme, Video, Nando, Andos, Mara, Cemias, Sesa, Aurol, Sendia. Female: Killian, Thraxa, Talya, Thorka, Thorlia, Avaxa, Ava, Vlana, Vlasha, Eildinda, Gila, Berta, Gelvan, Vico, Viso, Ardon, Valdo, Mundo, Afin, Crono, Alid, Lupe, Faxx, Thaxas, Brax.

Homelands: Aquila, Madrigal, Kitania, Dagor, Tuln, Guldur, the Emerald Isles.

Themes: Southmaren, Harn, Aquilan, Rochir, thief, adventurer, swashbuckler, city merchant, banker, traveling merchant, mercenary captain, ship captain, Black Wizard, priest, Aristocrat, thief, assassin, slave trader, ranger, traveler, scout, nomad.

Traits: sophisticated, streetwise, agile, quick, lucky, savvy, appraisal, artistic, witty, jaded, swordsmanship, traveling, riding, survival, desert survival, bushcraft.

Assets: cuirass, sidesword, buckler, parrying dagger, storta, spadone, partisan, crossbow, boots, guildmaster silver pin, spellbook, vial of poison, vial of poison antidote, deer meat, wineskin, traveling rations.

Signatures: black wizard spells, lock picking, magic appraisal, forgery, bribery, sword tricks, riding tricks, archery stick shot, horse whisperer, poison/antidote brewing.

Hooks: owes a debt, liar, thief, blackmailed, gigolo, flat broke, lost soul.

Paths: find a magical rapier, learn black wizard spells, make it rich, pay off debt, blood debt vs goblins, soul owned by a black wizard, orphan, raised by slave traders.

Æthiiri (Elves)

The Aethiiri (Elves) are beautiful hallowed Eldar of light, filled with sacred magic of the stars, moons, and music. Most Elves manifest aspects of the gods Lunara and Hirminel to the extent that being “Hallow” is often confused with being Elven, and some Elves have a visible silver halo. Elves are extraordinarily perceptive, and can see, feel, and find things invisible to mortal eyes. When they find people who are pure of heart they name them “Elf-friends”, and help them follow their call to become hallow servants of light. However, when Elves find hidden darkness they purge it with silver arrow and flaming sword, just as they have always confronted evil across the aeons, such as Kha’din daemons, Deurg’gul undead of Sepulcher, fallen “dark” Elves, and fallen Wyrms. As a result, Elves traveling in the young kingdoms are met with mixed feelings of awe, wonder, and fear that they might find an imperfection in mortal hearts. This fear means some kingdoms do not welcome them at all.

Eldar — double XP, two Signatures per character level instead of one; see [[Burners Experience#Eldar]].

Elven Names: Aegnor, Aerandir, Anarion, Anar, Annael, Aradan, Aranwe, Elros, Eluchil, Lenwe, Maglor, Aerin, Diora, Luthien, Morwen, Ilmare, Laurelin, Niniel, Rian. Surnames: Meadowbrook, Moonshadow, Blackthorn, Whitefeather, Harplight.

Themes: Elf, Ælf, Hallow, Saint, Ranger, White Wizard, Bladesinger, Battlesinger.

Traits: lithe, quick, beautiful, holy, light, moonlight, blessed of Lunara.

Assets: sword, bow, knife, spear, leaf armor, Elven cloak, silver trumpet, mandolin, harp, holy water, way bread.

Signatures: starlight, moonlight, healing touch, holy water, water of visions.

Hooks: vow of vengeance against the dark elves, family slain by Kha'din.

Paths: root out evil in the young kingdoms, find a weirstone of Lunara, learn a new song, bring a new saint to Lunara.

Illythrhi (Dark Elves)

Elves who turn away from the light of the Menelion are referred to as Illythiri, or “dark elves”. Lost from the light, they are unhallowed saints of dark gods. Hyakki has her “forest witches of the hunt” and Reshuk has his undead “Deurg-gul” of Sepulcher.

Alu

The sight of a masked Alu is enough to clear a busy street in any city. While similar in size to a Southmaren, the distinctive demon mask, robes, curved swords, hooks, and chains they carry mark them as “Alu Demons”, Eldar shadow warriors and deadly from the underworlds. Only arrogant fools stare at their swords or meet their red-gold eyes, for these are challenges to duel, and once drawn a hungry Alu blade must taste blood and souls before it may be sheathed.

Alu are famous duelists and swordsmen, known for being particularly devious adversaries with many secret and deceptive techniques. They wield distinctive curved and hooked swords of varying designs and lengths. The long edge is curved and ideal for broad sweeping cuts. Often weapons have hooks, lugs, chains, or cords for ensnaring and tripping. Such weapons are often of distinctive cultural design and use Eldar materials such as moonsilver, night iron, and bladegrass. Alu who always stand ready to fight are known as the Alu’Kel, and take that honorific after their name, such as “Arar’Kel”.

Alu traditionally hide their faces, either behind a hood, veil, or war mask, leaving only their red-gold eyes visible. Their war masks are terrifying, formed in the stylized visage of various “Gallu”, which is the word Alu use to describe the various demons of the underworlds, such as Oni, Ifr’it, Djinn, Tengu, Naga, Kha’din and all too many others. The Gallu visage is artistically embellished with elements of nature, spirits, and weapons. Alu masks are reputed to have magic powers, such as hiding the wearer from demons, shapeshifting into a demon, or ward pacts with bound demons.

Secretly, as one of the oldest of the Eldar, the Alu see it as one of their sacred duties to hunt, bind, and imprison wandering demons (“Gallu”) across the Dragon Isles. This ranges from minor monsters and spirits to major incursions that threaten the world, such as the Kha’din. To this end, Alu use various binding chains, hooks, and mystic rituals to ensnare and imprison demons into Kalla’din planar prisons. Indeed, many of the Alu ruins found across the Dragon Isles are prisons, best left unopened. Alu entrusted with this sacred duty are the Alu’Shem, and use that honorific after their name, such as “Ammon’Shem”. Some are reputed to call

upon bound powers in times of need, and may undergo transformations to take a Gallu visage or feature such as tengu wings or oni strength. Alu choose their words with care, for they know hidden power of words to bind, and true words are magically binding.

Alu Names: Ammon'Shem, Arar'Kel, Panur'Shem, Sago'Shem, Azzaz'Kel, Verash'Kel, Ara'Kel, Nina'Kel, Vera'Shem, Nezzera'Kel, Nim'Kel, Ran'Kel the Ghost Blade, Dim'Shem Binder of Gallu.

Homelands: Nan-Suruinen, Haradjia.

Themes: Alu, Alu Demon, Alu'Kel, assassin, Ifr'it, Haradjinn, Kha'din hunter, ninja, kensai, sohei shadow warrior, duellist, demon binder, tengu.

Traits: quick, light, agile, swift, agile, small, cunning, cruel, perceptive, clever, tumbling, leaping, rolling, parry, dodge, stealth, rope use, trapping, binding, climbing, water walking.

Assets: Alu demon mask, Alu silk robes, Alu bladegrass armor, Alu curved longsword (e.g. katana, scimitar, falchion, shotel), throwing dart knives (e.g. kunai, trumbash), hooked blades (e.g. sickle, kusari-gama, kama, khopesh, trumbash), bladegrass whip, night iron mail, hunting bow, longbow, silk slippers, horse, falcon, saffron, lamb, rice balls, sake bottle.

Signatures: arrow cutting, leaping, shadow step, invisibility, illusion, mirror image, shadow image, hide in shadows, shadow mask, binding words, circle of binding, binding chains, oni strength, tengu wings (grow from the back), shapeshift to Gallu.

Hooks: clan outcast, sole survivor, vengeful, consorts with shadows, assassin.

Paths: defeat an Akuma in single combat, hunt Kha'din and purge them, master a disguise, master the flute, recover an ancient sword, recover a demon mask.

Avathars

Avathars are a beautiful, dark, and deadly people feared the world over for their sinister schemes and cruelty. They tend to be tall and thin, stronger than they look, with supernatural grace, much like Elves. The unholy truth is they are Eldar demi-vampires with stolen Elven blood.

Do not enter the ash-cloaked lands of Nan-Avathar lightly and do not die there...

Avathars are often born the color of death, with pallid skin and white hair. Bright sunlight will blind or even scorch them like flame. The Avathar fashion dictates dramatic, flowing, cowled robes, and high-collared cloaks to protect from the searing sun and veil the wearer from sight. Even in the ashlands they need protection from the choking ash clouds and noxious gases spewed from volcanoes. Their mineral-rich volcanic land produces many colorful dyes, and while charcoal is the most practical hue the more wealthy Avathars dress with splendor. They wear riches from years of conquest, and supple fabrics like fine wool and velvet are richly embroidered in gothic designs, with threads of silver, gold, and precious stones. Even ebon-colored adamant can be given color and patterns by the introduction of various minerals in the fires of the forge.

Nan-Avathar is the domain of the Vampire Lords, a council of ancient necromancers, liches, and vampires, each immensely powerful in the arcane arts and aeons old. Avathars serve the Vampire Lords with great zeal, for these unholy half-dead have led the Avathars to world domination in the Vampire Wars of aeons past. The dead are by rights property of the Vampire Lords and their vassals. Avathar society is ancient and decadent; the nobility play high-stakes games at court, scheming in the shadows to gain favor with the Vampire Lords and displace their rivals. Assassinations by bolt, blade, or poison are frequent (although meticulously regulated by the Royal Avathar Society of Slayers).

Avathars worship the Duirgurth, the Gods of Death who preside over “the many deaths”. Death is a fearful affair with the promise of a living death on the surface, or eternal torment in some layer of hellish Duirgurth underworlds. The greatest of the Gods of Death is Kurg, the god of bloody battle, and the most devout of worshipers call themselves “Kurgans” and drink the blood of their foes. Some say with great foreboding that the Vampire Lords are building inverted ziggurat temples to the Duirgurth to channel and control energies, to bring the world into an eternal night.

Avathar Names: Alan, Dani, Dmitri, Ivan, Pavel, Vlad, Vristo, Vladmir, Vela, Trina, Vlina, Jara, Natasha, Sonja, Anna. Surnames: Tepsh, Snagov, Cragov, Drakh, Split, Hvar, Riva.

Themes: Avathar, Unhallow, Noble, Demi-Vampire, Assassin, Executioner, Kurgan, Necromancer, Undying, Necroalchemist (Royal Avathar Guild of Alchemists), Slayer (Royal Avathar Society of Slayers), Scourge (Royal Avathar Society of Scourges).

Traits: strong, beautiful, graceful, dark, unholy, sinister, scheming, ruthless, deadly cunning, cruel, patient.

Assets: black cape and hat, sunglasses/sungoggles, breath mask, plague doctor mask, gothic fluted plate armor, bat-winged ax, goupillon flail, mangual triple flail, longsword, executioner’s sword, greatsword, gothic halberd, siege arbalest, pavise, blood purity potion, healing potion in syringe, poison vial, poison dagger, poison antidote, belladonna perfume (poison), syringe, black bread, blood sausage, potatoes, wineskin.

Signatures: shadow sight, poison use, flail high guard, vampiricity, vampiric regeneration, vampiric immunities, bat familiar, wolf familiar, change to bat, change to wolf, energy drain, raise skeleton, raise zombie, corpse grinder, lifeblood, blood familiar, innate spells of death, negative energy channeling, headsman, blood sight, rage of Kurg, hunter of the unfaithful, immune to charm and sleep, create ash child.

Hooks: sunlight vulnerability, demi-vampiric (requires blood), schemer, vengeful and petty, deserter.

Paths: become a necromancer, become a Vampire Lord, gather Elf blood, capture thralls, corrupt a saint.

Baal

Baal are dragon worshipers from the “Draconian Empire” of Akkar. Baal are elegant Eldar with a touch of draconic; their skin is ash-like gray or black, often with small horns, bony ridges, sharp nails, and sometimes wings. Haughty, cruel, and greedy as dragons, Baal are looked upon with fear and loathing by most people. Human life has little value in their immortal eyes, and everyone has heard tales of the age when the Draconian empire stretched from sea to sea, enslaving all those within their reach. Their rituals of dragon worship call for burnt offerings of many kinds, but the Baal burn with a deeper purpose. Baal are often confused with Drisi serpent-men, especially by Northmarens who are often hostile to Eldar.

Baal Names: Jav’Tara, Vir’Hajas, Nur’Ash, Gor’Ash, Amon’Kel, Ev’Shem, Herek’Gor, Tov Morden’Yr, Tak’Jat, Ton’Hajak, Kajas’Gor.

Themes: Baal, Dragon Lord, Pyromancer, Dragon Knight, Baal’Kel, Baal’Yr.

Traits: noble, dragon-scarred, bony skin, commanding voice, haughty, greedy, resist fire.

Assets: silk robes, ornate silk hat, fluted plate armor, flamberge sword, spear, smoked meat, water, incense, book of dragon rituals.

Signatures: speak for dragons, conjure flames, purifying flames (burns Taint), flaming sword, flame circle (ritual), immune to charm and sleep, sacrificial rites (ritual), summon dragon, dragon scales (manifests scale armor as an Innate Asset), dragon wings (grow from the back).

Hooks: as greedy and cruel as any dragon, secretly a Baal’Mot.

Paths: find a dragon to serve, expand the Regio of my dragon, purge all Baal’Mot.

Baal Names & Titles. The Baal believe names and titles have power, and create mystical connections through similarity, and this repeats across aeons.

- **Uru:** A dragon, bound to guard the Node where it was hatched. Uru can be slain but do not die, they only sleep until they are reborn as a draconia, and perhaps again as a dragon if they earn the favor of the Dragon Gods.
- **Baal'Seta:** A Baal noble, one who bears the seta'al dragon scars that show him to have the favor of the dragons. One needs not be born as a Baal, the dragons sometimes mark foreigners. The dragons mark the face, so all can witness and none can deny their signs of favor. Causes distrust in Kith.
- **Baal'Shem:** dragon priest, a Baal'Seta who solely lives to serve the dragons, perform their sacred rituals (which often involve burnt offerings). Baal'Shem are the voice of the dragons and the Dragon Gods to Baal people.
- **Baal'Kel:** knight or warrior, whose role is to be a weapon. Their name is the name of their weapon, and their weapon bears their name.
- **Baal'Yr:** artificer, skilled in alchemy and enchantment, whose role is to create.
- **Baal'Na:** abbot, ruler of a monastery. Na'Eslin is the monastery of the abbot Baal'Na'Eslin and home of the dragon Eslin.
- **Baal'Rhi:** king or prince, ruler of a great city. Rhi'Annon is the great city ruled by the king Baal'Rhi'Annon and guarded by the dragon Annon.
- **Baal'Si:** duke or count, ruler of a stronghold. Si'Anwon is a stronghold ruled by lord Baal'Si'Anwon and guarded by the dragon Anwon.
- **Baal'Er:** eyrie lord, ruler of a great watchtower. Er'Hajak is a watchtower ruled by lord Baal'Er'Hajak and guarded by the dragon Hajak.
- **Baal'Mot:** priest of the caste [once long ago] responsible for rituals of life and death (this name has been forgotten, and speaking this name is punished with death).

Drisi

The Drisi are the Eldar “serpent-men”, servants of the Gorgonae serpent gods, old enemies of mankind. Their cold-blooded empire periodically slithers from the underworlds to cover the world in coils of slavery and deceit, then cycles into dormancy, like a snake shedding and renewing its skin.

Drisi appear as Southmarens and can blend in with human society anywhere, yet they are not what they seem to be. Drisi live to serve the Gorgonae serpent gods, and receive gifts as rewards for faithful service, such as snakes for hair, fangs, claws, scales, snake head, tail, and other snake, serpent, or draconian features such as spines and even dragon wings. Accomplished Drisi have many gifts, yet, these gifts are secrets of the serpent gods, revealed only to their saints, and so Drisi serpent-men are indistinguishable from Baal and Southmarens unless they choose to reveal these gifts to the world.

The serpent gods are renowned for their wickedness, as well as their wisdom and powers of renewal, healing, and resurrection. Also known as the Gorgonae, they have been known across the aeons by a great many names, such as Tark, Hypsiglena, Yigg, Set, Ningishzida, Asclepius, Hygeia, Panacea, Aceso, Vilothuus, Yyg, and Nisi. Their necroalchemist priests traditionally took the surname “-Mot”, although this fell out of favor after a great war with the Baal, who took issue with the Drisi-Mot claiming dragons were hatched from the moons and sacrificing them to the Gorgonae.

Drisi ruins are common, such as snake-carved pyramids, crypts, slave pits, and sacrificial altars to the dark serpent gods, and these places are filled with glittering treasures as well as grave peril. The Eldar serpentmen were masters of sorcery and necroalchemy, and left behind caches of potions, poisons, salves, healing unguents, and oils, most of which last indefinitely in preparation for the end times. Rarer still are Drisi libraries, housing the skins of snakes, dragons, strange beasts, Eldar, humans, and others, each of which can be read like a book to learn their story. In this regard, snakes prove superior since they shed their skins and need not be skinned.

Drisi warriors are known for their skill with the spear, javelin, partisan, and curved swords and axes. They often prefer shields over armor, since many of their heroes of legend were reputed to be encased in tough scales, gifted by the gods, as well as other weapons such as venomous snake hair. Their weapons are often made of alchemical steels, such as ever sharp black adamant, magic-soaking brassy orichalcum, or venomous purple vakaar.

Drisi Names: Amon, Ammon, Amon-Mot, Amosis, Angrboda, A'rthuun-Mot, D'irz, D'aergul, D'ras, E'rthane, Hypnalis, Imhotep, Im'Ravin-Mot, K'alaban, Khafra, K'kai, K'nren, L'lanir, Mesedsure, Moraga, Nedjem, Neferet, Rameses, R'enn, R'leth, Set ("man of Seth"), Tahemet, Y'quis, Y'sis.

Homelands: Aquila, Ashenrise, Underworlds of Valusia, Necroalchemical Empire of Ahr'Tolth, Kalla'Drisi, the Cave of Serpents, The Nameless City.

Themes: Drisi, Nisi, Nisibisi, Draconian, Serpentman, Gorgon, Linnorm, Naga, Desert Viper, Drisi-Mot, Son of Hecate, Son of Hypsiglena, Necroalchemist, Draconecroalchemist.

Traits: serpentine, scales, serpent speed, cold eyes, snakes for hair, snake tail, devious, adaptable, beguiling, calculating patient, planner, mastermind, deceptive.

Assets: dory (light spear), aspis (shield), dagger, khopesh (sickle sword), crescent moon ax, crescent moon spade, gada (mace), monk spade, pilose (conical helm), orichalcum aspis, orichalcum pilose, adamant dory, orichalcum khopesh, vakaar dagger.

Signatures: charm person, charm snakes, sticks to snakes, spray poison, suggestion.

Drisi Gifts: Take an Innate Asset for each of your "gifts", e.g. serpent scale armor, dragon scale armor, snakes for hair, poison bite, poison blood, heat vision (q.v. pit viper), sleep venom, etc. Also take a "Drisi Gifts" Signature; when used this manifests your gifts, making them available to use as well as visible. Otherwise you appear human, and your gifts are unavailable to use, as well as undetectable.

Hooks: disguised serpentman, owes sacrifices to Set.

Paths: become a son of Set, build a cult of Set, summon the Yellow King, summon an avatar of Vilothuus, find a lost bowl of Hygeia or staff of Asclepius, find a great library, subvert a human kingdom.

Dwür (Dwarves)

Dwür are often described as dwarves or gnomes, short of stature, wizened and with dour yet hearty demeanor. They love places and things which are beautifully and well-made, so they tend to live in large cities, where they often achieve renown as masterful builders and artisans.

Even Dwur who wander afar from the forge are sure to carry tools to tinker and fix gear. Also they will strapped with guns. Multiple guns. Dwur love guns, and why not! Are they not the pinnacle of engineering and beauty? When the gods made the Dwur they challenged them to create something even greater: guns. (Some say guns are tied with beer.) Since the best guns are magic guns, the Dwur engrave their Runeguns with thaumaturgic runes.

Names: Athan, Davon, Durgir, Rugrir, Runon, Thovil, Bador, Adiel, Rura, Runa.

Homelands: Aegis, Aquila, Ashenrise, Alglondor, Belerion, Lyonesse.

Themes: Dwur, Dwarf, Dwarrow, Thaumaturge, Runemaster, Gunner, Artillery Captain, Rifleman, Gunsmith, Builder, Craftsman, Brewmaster.

Traits: dour, solid, vengeful, hearty, patient as stone, strong as stone, beardy, beer lover.

Assets: hammer, axe, skullcap, three-quarter plate armor, tinkering tools, crafting tools, lantern, flintlock pistol, flintlock rifle, blunderbuss, runelock, sausages, beer, whiskey.

Signatures: Runelock, create golem, craft Dwurstone.

Hooks: family slain by Gobbah, quest of vengeance.

Paths: invent something new, craft a new gun, visit a new young kingdom, regain the old Dwur homelands in Forandol mountains.

Dwur History

Dwur history is the history of Dragon Isles. Their homelands are deep in the Forandol mountains in the north, where they spent aeons carving the mountain peaks into breathtaking halls. Their bright halls were filled with wondrous works, given life by Dwur thaumaturgic runes. This was aeons ago, and they fled during The Breaking, scattering to the winds.

Many Dwur joined the Baal in their sacred quest to reclaim the Dragon Isles from the Kha'din. The Dwur built roads and canals connecting the Dragon Isles, overlooked by watchtowers and shrines. These works were made from Dwurstone, black basalt sturdily wrought and carved with thaumaturgic runes, which was even capable of giving life to the Karrocks. The Dwur also forged runeblades, dragon-winged plate armor, and dragon-mouthed thaumacannons. Many of these works survive and shape the landscape of the Dragon Isles. This alliance ended bitterly once the Baal finished their shared quest and then sought to grow their power into the Draconian Empire. The Baal-Dwur schism led to the fall of the empire, and the world is now facing Kha'din again.

Indeed, if Dwur have a fault, it is their memories. Dwur remember all, never forgive, and never forget. It can take a lifetime to earn their trust, yet, a single act of betrayal to lose it forever. They remember all the long dark wars of the past, and remain bitter enemies of the Gobbah, Drisi, Baal, and Deurg'dul undeads of Sepulcher. Some still seek vengeance to this day, but prefer to ally with Northmarens and serve as elite artillery and gunnery troops rather than foot soldiers.

Dwürgaur (Dark Dwur)

Not all Dwur seek the light. The Dwürgaur tunneled deep and away from the bright peaks. Life in the depths changed them, and now they are enemies of the Dwur and all surface dwellers. Some say they are the remnants of the Dwur who were lost in the Battle of the Thousandfold Curses, who now seek vengeance for being left behind and sealed into the abandoned Dwur halls.

Karrocks

Karrocks have the appearance of classical heroic statues come to life, each a study in fine art. Indeed, they are as living works of art, with impassive gazes revealing emotions both human and inhuman at the same time.

Karrocks have a quiet wisdom, usually leading peaceful lives outdoors, often in remote mountains, seemingly unfettered by modern concerns. They tend to not place much value on physical belongings; for example tend to dress simply, which works for them to better draw attention to their classical faces and physiques. However, this serene calm is only possible because they have found the path to allow stress to live within them, not to avoid it.

Karrocks were created as war machines of the Draconian Empire. Dwur sculpted the Karrocks in heartstone and gave them life with thaumaturgical runes of power. These warriors of living stone were practically impervious to harm, proof against blades, Drisi poison, necromantic magics, and the Baalfire of renegade dragons and wyrms. They were able to tunnel and shape stone to sap strongholds or dragon caves. After the great wars the Dwur gave the Karrocks humanity to live their lives in freedom. Their bodies became flesh and blood, but they could still wield mystical gifts of stone shaping when needed. Many sought solace in remote mountain tops far from human kingdoms, to live simple monastic lives of contemplation. However,

some Karrocks seek to atone for the damage they once caused, helping and protecting the people they once crushed under stone heels. Despite this, most Karrocks hold no regret over fighting the Drisi serpent people or Wyrms.

Although Karrocks were given humanity by the Dwur and can lead mortal lives, they are Eldar who bear thaumaturgical runes of living stone. Karrocks can tap those runes to transform back to their original body of living stone. The runes also form a sympathetic connection with stone, and many Karrocks are able to wield this power to shape stone as if it were clay, or pull stone objects such as great clubs from the ground. Karrocks can use their “runes of living stone” to avoid normal human needs such as food, clothing and shelter, outlasting a famine or winter storm by turning to stone. However, these runes must be fed earth power to develop and keep their power strong, so Karrocks constantly seek out gems and precious stones containing blessings of Xohm, the Earth Mother.

Karrock Names: Athan, Davon, Durgir, Galatan, Krego, Rugrir, Runon, Thovil, Bador, Adiel, Galatea, Rura, Runa.

Homelands: Algondor, Nan-Surinen, Sepulchre, the Platinum Peaks.

Themes: Karrock, Exemplar Saint of Xohm, Wrestler, Warrior-poet, Priest, Yamabushi, Sohei, Wanderer.

Traits: solid, hearty, wrestling, tall, huge, strong, voice like a mountain, baritone, patient as stone, stoic, tough as stone, strong as a mountain, contemplative, meditation, unyielding.

Assets: stone mace, stone maul, poleax, iron-shod staff, tetsubo, lantern, colorful cloak, monk robes, simple loincloth, sausages, beer, whiskey.

Signatures: feat of strength, summon greatclub, stone shape, shape stone, earth shatter.

Karrock Gifts: Take an Innate Asset for each of your “Karrock gifts” when you are made of stone, e.g. stonesskin, stonesshirt, stonefists, etc. Also take a “Karrock Gifts” Signature; when used this manifests those Innate Assets, making them available to use as well as visible. Otherwise you appear human, and your gifts are unavailable to use, as well as undetectable.

Hooks: war atrocities, recurring war nightmares.

Paths: find the Karrock homeland, find an arkenstone, become truly patient.

Karrock Paths: You can consume gems and precious stones to earn XP on Paths for Karrock Gifts. (Tip: look up reputed gemstone powers for inspiration.) For example, you might work towards gaining a “stone strength” Trait or Signature by consuming a precious stone (such as agate or black onyx). Also if you find a truly magical stone then you may be able to gain its power.

Kith

The Kith are the rarest and grimmest of warriors, feared the world over for their immense strength and ferocity. Legend tells that their ancestors were Wyrmskrøl “dragonslayers”, who hunted wild beasts, monsters, and dragons, then in tradition ate the hearts of their prey to gain all the qualities of the beast: bravery, strength, agility, and from dragons came healing and immortality.

Each Kith is an alpha predator, a peerless hunter and warrior, yet seeks to outdo the feats of past great heroes and build an even greater name and legend that will last for all time.

Kith of legend often cast as musclebound berserkers half-naked in animal skins, wielding giant weapons, howling and murdering and like feral animals, and immune to wounds. Many live by the words “you keep what you kill”, only owning and carrying what was pried from the grasp of vanquished foes, even going so far as to keep “drinking skulls” as trophies from especially worthy foes or prey. Kith often fasten belongings which can’t be worn with cords or chains. All the myths are true, but the Kith are also Eldar, and some are

just as civilized as any northmaren. Some Kith do indeed tower above even the northmen, and some have a bestial ferocity, but many others have the calm, quiet and determined demeanor of a seasoned hunter who stalks deadly monsters, yet prevails via cunning.

The ancestors of the Kith came from the far northern lands of the midnight sun, which they call Hrivlyggdor. The cold mountains, tundra, forests and rivers of the north are teeming with big game for the hunt. The weather alone can kill, heightening the challenge when hunting monsters such as cave bears, giants, dragons, wyrms, and underworld cities of Drisi and Drones. Many Kith return to this ancient homeland as a rite of passage, seeking to test and find themselves. Yet, this land is no longer their home, which is amongst the northmarens and southmarens who struggle against monsters, wyrms, and oppressive Eldar empires, and are in need of a hero.

Kith Names: Alva, Asger, Aslog, Balder, Bard, Beowulf, Bjorn, Brant, Canute, Dag, Dagmar, Egil, Eirik, Fafnir, Freja, Haldor, Halvard, Helle, Hjalmar, Inge, Ivar, Jarl, Jormunrek, Niflung, Odin, Ottir, Siggeir, Sigi, Sigurd, Sorli, Regan, Regin, Rerir, Rodingeir, Tarben, Thor, Thorsen, Thorvaldr, Thurmond, Tyr, Tyra, Unn, Vali, Volsung, Ylva.

Homelands: Hrivlyggdor, Ashenrise, The Wolf's Maw, Belerion, Lyonesse.

Themes: Kith, Wyrmskrøl, wyrmslayer, dragonslayer, warrior, ranger, scout, berserker, monster hunter, giantsbane, werewolf trapper.

Traits: hard to kill, strong, hunting, trapping, scouting, stealth, unstoppable, force of nature, resilient, axeman, swordsman, spearman, courageous, resilient, skald, bowyer, bushcraft, wood lore.

Assets: greatsword, lochaber ax, dragonbone axe, saex, small ax, dragonbone dagger, war bow, war drum, cloak (esp. deer hide, wolf, bear, etc.), drinking skull, venison, grog, gold wrist band, gold torc.

Signatures: understand bird's song, dragon eyes, dragon skin, dragon awe, burning blood, burning eye, stone heart, dragon fury, strength of the wyrm.

Hooks: seeks pain, only own what I can carry, keeps drinking skulls, family slain by Baal/Drones/Drisi/Wyrms.

Paths: master the winged axe, master the dragonspear, master the greatsword, slay a wyrm, slay a dragon, slay Baal, slay Drones, raid Baal lands, establish trade with the south.

Vôzen

Vôzen are doppelgängers who can take on the appearance and mannerisms of other people. Given time they can mimic the complete identity of any person. Vôzen are Eldar, and have been living this way for aeons... they could be anyone you meet, and unless you learn their "tells" you'll never know the difference.

Perfecting anything takes time, and each Vôzen develops only a few identities over their lifetime. Any given identity has a name, ancestry, face, voice, and the countless other details that make up a full, believable persona. Vôzen who travel might have different identities for each region, or parts of a city. As Eldar, they might have identities from long ago which could seem antiquated in our time, or might even have been famous people. Vôzen try to avoid their doppelgängers, since their reactions are often violent. Many Vôzen have taken action to eliminate their doppelgängers, i.e. murder them, which made their generally unsavory reputation even worse. As a result, even honest Vôzen keep their true nature secret for fear of retribution.

The unique Vôzen gifts stem from alchemy. They have alchemical blood, which provides superhuman observation and adaptation, as well as their well-known ability to change shape. In fact, some Vôzen learn to take on the shape of objects such as furniture or shrubberies instead of people. Some Vôzen have also proven able learn new abilities by studying alchemy, especially using magic potions and alchemical elixirs. For example, a Vôzen might learn to self-heal by carefully absorbing the contents of a potion of healing.

Vôzen are Eldar with ancient origins. Aeons ago, the Baal'Yr alchemists discovered the native peoples of the Vôkrazum jungles, which to everyone else is an inhospitable, toxic environment with rare and deadly alchemical compounds and fungi. The Baal'Yr were intrigued and used their alchemical arts to study, and subsequently enhance the Vôzen, creating perfect scouts, spies, and agents for the Draconian Empire. The processes used were experimental, painful, and inhuman, but ultimately resulted in what the Vôzen are today, a people transformed by alchemy with superhuman gifts. However, due to this ancestral trauma Vôzen have an innate terror of fire, and this is entirely rational since extreme heat has the potential to destabilize their alchemical composition. As a result, most Vôzen eschew fire, and even go so far as to favor bland, uncooked food.

Vôzen Names: correspond to the current identity.

Themes: Vôzen, Scout, Explorer, Spy, Alchemist, Actor, Merchant, Ambassador, Emissary, Investigator, Bodyguard, Adventurer.

Traits: adaptable, observant, disguise, linguistics, voice actor, disguise, mimicry, acting, stagecraft, ventriloquism, alchemy.

Assets: sidesword, dagger, merchant's outfit, alchemists robes, master alchemist pin, potion of healing, potion of water breathing, alchemy kit.

Signatures: one secret identity, breathe water, squeeze flat, survive fall.

Identity Signatures: Each identity is a Signature. When you use the identity Signature you instantly assume that identity, and remain that way until you use a different identity Signature or want to go back to your own identity.

Hooks: fears fire, fears hot water, fears spicy food, fears dragons and Baal, fears helplessness/capture, murdered one of my doppelgängers, secretly a spy, always takes any potions found.

Paths: sip my potion of water breathing to learn how to breath water, overcome fear of fire, tip my potion of healing to learn how to heal myself, learn to endure spicy food, perfect next identity, go bush camping, kill off my doppelgängers, steal the identity of a noble/merchant/alchemist.

Alchemical Paths: You can sip Potions to gain XP towards Paths dealing with alchemical pursuits or powers. For example, you might work towards gaining a "strength" Trait or Signature by sipping a potion of strength. Sipping a potion lets you know what the potion does, but does not trigger any of the normal potion effects or side effects. You get XP after sipping all of the potion. You can also consume alchemical components, working towards the reputed or presumed abilities of that component. For example the "heart of a basilisk" might allow you to "resist petrification" or gain the ability to change your "stone to flesh".